supposed take turns in accompanying the village headman on tours related to official business. *Vanaprashta*s or forest recluses had allotments in the forests for habitation and were permitted to take salt free of charge for consumption. The *Chandala*s were the untouchables, governed by strict rules on segregation and movement.

The secret service or spies disguised themselves as ascetics and traders in other kingdoms, but there were also secret agents deployed to keep track of arrivals and departures within the kingdom. Lodging within the city was carefully monitored with merchants, artisans and artists allowed to accommodate visitors only from their own professions. Suspicious activity at eating places and brothels was to be reported to the authorities.

In the Kautilyan world, women's position was one of dependence on men. This was reflected in the curtailment of their movement as long as they were not courtesans, in which case they were encouraged to travel even during battle expeditions and motivate the men to fight. The wife had to take permission from her husband to go on pleasure trips and could not leave the house when he was drunk or asleep. The categories of punishment for various forms of leaving the house are listed in great detail in the *Arthashastra.* There were also detailed regulations regarding the absence of the husband for long periods, including oversight of the women left behind and punishments such as the nose and an ear being cut off in case the woman committed adultery. In case of domestic abuse, the wife could run away from the husband and it would be the responsibility of the village headman to give asylum to such women. She could always visit her own family on special occasions such as childbirth, death and illness.

Another aspect of migration was linked with the policies to counter famines, an age-old calamity in India that was the result of the failure of the monsoon that brought over 90 per cent of the rainfall to the Indian subcontinent between June and September every year. Kautilya recommended migration to different regions, and even the movement of entire populations including the king and court to places with abundant harvests or those near water bodies. Similarly, there were policies for new areas to be cleared and inhabited by Shudras deported from overpopulated